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Bird, generic

3.1 Bird, generic

References:

Hebrew בַּעַל כָּנָף (ba‘al kanaf) PRO 1:17, ECC 10:20

Hebrew עוֹף (‘of) GEN 1:20, GEN 1:21, GEN 1:22, GEN 1:26, GEN 1:28, GEN 1:30, GEN 2:19, GEN 2:20, GEN 6:7, GEN 6:20, GEN 7:3, GEN 7:8, GEN 7:14, GEN 7:21, GEN 7:23, GEN 8:17, GEN 8:19, GEN 8:20, GEN 9:2, GEN 9:10, GEN 40:17, GEN 40:19, LEV 1:14, LEV 7:26, LEV 11:13, LEV 11:20, LEV 11:21, LEV 11:23, LEV 11:46, LEV 17:13, LEV 20:25, LEV 20:25, DEU 14:19, DEU 14:20, DEU 28:26, 1SA 17:44, 1SA 17:46, 2SA 21:10, 1KI 5:13, 1KI 14:11, 1KI 16:4, 1KI 21:24, JOB 12:7, JOB 28:21, JOB 35:11, PSA 50:11, PSA 78:27, PSA 79:2, PSA 104:12, ECC 10:20, ISA 16:2, JER 4:25, JER 5:27, JER 7:33, JER 9:9, JER 12:4, JER 15:3, JER 16:4, JER 19:7, JER 34:20, EZK 29:5, EZK 31:6, EZK 31:13, EZK 32:4, EZK 38:20, EZK 44:31, HOS 2:20, HOS 4:3, HOS 7:12, HOS 9:11, ZEP 1:3

Hebrew עַיִט (‘ayit) GEN 15:11, JOB 28:7, ISA 18:6, ISA 18:6, ISA 46:11, JER 12:9, JER 12:9, EZK 39:4

Hebrew צִפּוֹר, צִפֹּר (tsippor, tsippar) GEN 7:14, GEN 15:10, LEV 14:4, LEV 14:5, LEV 14:6, LEV 14:6, LEV 14:6, LEV 14:7, LEV 14:49, LEV 14:50, LEV 14:51, LEV 14:51, LEV 14:52, LEV 14:52, LEV 14:53, DEU 4:17, DEU 14:11, DEU 22:6, NEH 5:18, JOB 40:29, PSA 8:9, PSA 11:1, PSA 102:8, PSA 104:17, PSA 124:7, PSA 148:10, PRO 6:5, PRO 7:23, PRO 27:8, ECC 9:12, ISA 31:5, LAM 3:52, EZK 17:23, EZK 39:4, EZK 39:17, DAN 4:9, DAN 4:11, DAN 4:18, DAN 4:30, HOS 11:11, AMO 3:5

Greek ὄρνεον (orneon) REV 18:2, REV 19:17, REV 19:21, WIS 5:11, WIS 17:17, WIS 19:11, BAR 3:17, LJE 1:21, LJE 1:70, 2MA 15:33, 4MA 1:34, ODA 2:24

Greek πετεινός (peteinon) MAT 6:26, MAT 8:20, MAT 13:4, MAT 13:32, MRK 4:4, MRK 4:32, LUK 8:5, LUK 9:58, LUK 12:24, LUK 13:19, ACT 10:12, ACT 11:6, ROM 1:23, JAS 3:7, JDT 11:7, ESG 8:12, SIR 11:3, SIR 17:4, 4MA 14:15, ODA 8:80, PSS 5:9

Greek πτηνόν (ptēnon) 1CO 15:39

Greek οἰωνόβρωτος (oiōnobrōtos) 2MA 9:15, 3MA 6:34

Latin volatilis 2ES 5:6, 2ES 5:26, 2ES 6:47

Discussion:

The Hebrew word tsippor generally refers to small birds about the size of the sparrow, while the word ‘ayit, where it refers to a bird and not an animal, refers to any large bird of prey. In the New Testament the Greek word **orneon** refers to birds of prey, but in the deuterocanonical books this word is used to refer to birds in general. In the books of Maccabees the word for birds of prey is oiōnobrōtos. The remaining Hebrew and Greek words are all used for birds in general, and if the size or type of bird is important, the specific type is indicated by the individual context. The Latin word volatilis is also a general word for birds of all kinds.

Special significance and symbolism

Birds, especially birds of prey, are often, but not always, used in Scripture as symbols of uncleanness or disaster. This seems to be related to the fact that in warfare, the unburied corpses of the dead are fed on by vultures, eagles, and crows.

Translation:

In some languages the word for birds of prey may be quite different from the word for birds that are eaten, such as partridges, pheasants, chickens, jungle fowl, ducks, geese, and others, and these in turn may be referred to by a different word from the one used for small birds that are not normally eaten. In languages where this is the case, careful attention should be paid to the individual contexts to make sure that the most suitable word is being used.